

The argument that AI data centers consume a lot of water locally or are generally harmful locally is somewhat ridiculous because wouldn't relocating the data centers solve this problem? Data centers that are built without regard for local interests are not an AI problem, but a local construction.

Posted by u/Questioner8297 • 0 points • 15 comments

Speaking of water, we know that water only changes form, it doesn't disappear. Steam is still water. Fundamentally, for the entire planet, "water consumption" is completely unimportant. As for local issues, well, you can build data centers where water is not a problem.

Comments

u/Odd_Diver_7249 • 1 points • 2026-03-27 19:14 UTC

They should build them in the ocean. I think Microsoft did some experiments with that

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2026-03-27 18:52 UTC

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u/Silly-Pressure4959 • 1 points • 2026-03-27 18:48 UTC

Yeah, its actually pretty great in the end that the major criticisms (water, energy) are 2 things we know perfectly well how to do in a completely renewable way. The future is pretty bright, especially considering no one on the planet wants datacenters to be more energy efficient than the AI companies.

u/Belisaurius555 • 0 points • 2026-03-27 18:34 UTC

You Could...but current AI development is being made by private interests. They pick places where the property value is low and local government is weak. Easy access to clean drinking water drives up property values and allows a larger population with a stronger government.

Yes, this is a capitalism thing but the AI we hate the most only exists because of capitalism.

u/Bra--ket • 1 points • 2026-03-27 18:23 UTC

They don't relocate them because they're in the cheapest location already. These areas already had water budget issues.

And these data centers were approved, regardless, because they barely impact it.

u/Civil-War-7857 • 2 points • 2026-03-27 18:26 UTC

These data centers were approved not because they barely impact it but because of monied interests.

u/Bra--ket • 1 points • 2026-03-27 18:27 UTC

It's because the monied interests were proven by the lack of impact. It's both.

u/Civil-War-7857 • 2 points • 2026-03-27 18:31 UTC

lol, lmao even.

The delusions of a person who doesnt have to live near one of these resource siphoning trash plants

u/Bra--ket • 2 points • 2026-03-27 18:25 UTC

If you want a real answer, it's cause some 80-year-old guy on the zoning board was shown a graph on how his town will make more money if they let him build it here so he signed a piece of paper.

Good luck trying to convince him he did the wrong thing when they put a million dollars in his back pocket.

u/plamzito • -1 points • 2026-03-27 18:17 UTC

As they say, please find a school bus, and then get on it.

u/Civil-War-7857 • 0 points • 2026-03-27 18:15 UTC

"Water consumption is completely unimportant"

Tell me dear poster, what happens to the fresh water when it gets dropped it into a massive pool of salt water like the ocean?

And good luck getting the uber wealthy who own these datacenters to spend the money constructing new facilities and moving all their infrastructure into them.

u/Questioner8297 • 1 points • 2026-03-27 18:39 UTC

You're saying that salt water isn't responsible for the largest amount of evaporation. Water evaporates from the ocean, then flows onto land, falls, and there you have your freshwater river.

u/Civil-War-7857 • 0 points • 2026-03-27 18:55 UTC

Now take into account scale of consumption of fresh potable water and compare it to what comes back as fresh water from the water cycle.

u/Bra--ket • 2 points • 2026-03-27 18:20 UTC

Well they said for the entire planet. They mean it's only a local issue like you said.

u/Civil-War-7857 • -1 points • 2026-03-27 18:25 UTC

ah local issues so it doesnt matter and wont impact the larger picture of things?

u/Bra--ket • 2 points • 2026-03-27 18:28 UTC

You're just misrepresenting his point, that's all I'm saying.